
AMAZON BRAND PROTECTION

The Unauthorized Seller Playbook

How to find them, remove them,
and keep them off your listings.

The system OBG runs internally — laid out step by step. No fluff.

INSIDE THIS PLAYBOOK

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| 01 Why 3P beats 1P for protection | 02 Diagnose your seller landscape |
| 03 The 7-step removal sequence | 04 Phase A / B / C action plan |

FROM THE DESK OF ONLINE BRAND GROWTH

If you're reading this, you already know the feeling.

You log into Seller Central, check your listing, and see four other sellers offering *your* product — at prices that don't make sense, with photography you didn't approve, and reviews complaining about a product that isn't yours.

Your Buy Box share is dropping. Your authorized retailers are calling. And every time you remove one seller, two more pop up by Friday.

We're a founder-led Amazon brand management agency. Across our team's careers we've built and scaled hundreds of brands on Amazon — and this playbook is the same step-by-step system we run internally for the operators we partner with today. No fluff, no theory. Just the exact moves, in the exact order, that get unauthorized sellers off your listings and keep them off.

Work through it section by section. By the time you finish, you'll have a defensible Amazon channel — one that protects your margin, your retail partners, and the brand you've spent years building.

— The Online Brand Growth Team

Amazon Brand Management Specialists

TIP

How to use this playbook

Each section ends with a clear action step. Don't try to do everything at once — work the **Audit Foundation Removal Prevention** sequence in order. How long the whole system takes depends on your trademark status, your contract redlines, and how deep the unauthorized-seller problem already runs. It's a sequence, not a deadline.

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01

SECTION 01

Why this matters

The real cost of letting unauthorized sellers run on your listings.

Counterfeits and unauthorized resale are not edge cases — they are a structural feature of global commerce. The question isn't whether your brand will be hit. It's how prepared you are when it happens.

\$467B

global counterfeit trade
per OECD/EUIPO

15M+

counterfeit units Amazon
seized in 2024

24,000+

bad actors pursued by
Amazon's CCU since 2020

Sources: OECD/EUIPO global trade in fakes; Amazon Brand Protection Report 2024; Amazon Counterfeit Crimes Unit.

Why it gets worse before it gets better

Unauthorized sellers don't just steal margin once. They train Amazon's algorithm to reward whoever wins the Buy Box most often — and they win by undercutting your MAP. Over time, that low price *becomes* the reference price. Your authorized retailers see it, refuse to match it, and quietly stop reordering.

Worse: when an unauthorized seller fulfills a defective unit, the negative review attaches to *your* ASIN. You take the rating hit. You eat the return. You absorb the A-to-Z guarantee claim. And Amazon's Account Health team starts asking questions you can't answer.

WATCH OUT**How the math compounds — a worked example**

If unauthorized sellers hold the Buy Box 30% of the time, that's not a discount on your sale — it's **your sale, gone**. 30% of revenue, off the top. At a 40% gross margin, that's roughly 12% of net profit before any other damage. Then layer in: returns and A-to-Z claims absorbed by your account on units they fulfilled, ad spend wasted driving traffic to a hijacked Buy Box, and authorized retailers who churn once your channel pricing collapses. The actual hit to net profit is materially larger than the headline Buy Box loss. Run the math on your own numbers.

02

SECTION 02

How unauthorized sellers damage your brand

Five distinct attack vectors — and the cost signature of each.

Not every rogue seller is the same. The remediation that works for a discount diverter won't work for a counterfeiter. Identify which type you're facing before you pick a tactic.

Buy Box Hijackers

Resellers who undercut your MAP to win the Buy Box, eroding margin across the entire channel.

Diverter

Wholesale customers reselling on Amazon outside their contract — your own product, but in a channel they aren't authorized for.

Counterfeiters

Sellers shipping fake or knock-off units under your ASIN. Highest brand-damage risk, fastest review collapse.

Bundle / Variation Hijackers

Sellers piggybacking on your listings with re-bundled or modified versions, confusing customers and tanking conversion.

Listing Saboteurs

Bad-actor competitors who edit your title, images, or bullets through the Contributions tool to hurt CTR.

TIP**Tag every rogue with a vector**

When you build your seller log (Section 03), tag each one with the vector type. Your removal letter, evidence pack, and Amazon report all change based on the tag. Mixing vectors is the #1 reason takedown attempts get dismissed.

How to identify which vector you're dealing with

Run this diagnostic before you write a single takedown letter. The wrong remedy applied to the wrong vector wastes legal budget and signals to Amazon that you don't know your own channel.

Is the price below MAP?	Yes Hijacker or Diverter. No likely a saboteur or counterfeiter.
Is the unit identical to yours when test-purchased?	Yes Hijacker or Diverter. No Counterfeiter (escalate immediately).
Did the seller buy from your wholesale channel?	Yes Diverter — your contract is the leverage. No external acquisition route.
Did your title, bullets, or images recently change without your edit?	Yes Listing Saboteur — file a Brand Registry violation.
Is the seller consistently appearing across multiple ASINs?	Yes organized arbitrage, not opportunistic — needs a coordinated takedown.

ACTION

Action — Build your vector map

Open a spreadsheet. List every non-authorized seller currently on your top 20 ASINs. Tag each one with a vector. Sort by vector. **That spreadsheet becomes your enforcement battle plan.**

03

SECTION 03

Diagnose your seller landscape

The 5-step audit every brand should run before launching any takedown.

You can't remove what you can't see. Most brand owners systematically underestimate their unauthorized-seller count because they only look at their hero ASINs and only check during business hours. Run this audit on every active product, at least monthly.

1

Pull a complete ASIN inventory

Export your full catalog from Seller Central or Vendor Central. Include parent and child ASINs, variations, and any retired listings that still have offer activity. Don't skip discontinued SKUs — they're prime hijacker targets because no one's watching.

2

Snapshot the Offer Listings page for every live ASIN

For each ASIN, capture the full Offers page (the one customers see when clicking 'New & Used from'). Use a Brand Registry tool, an Amazon scraper, or screenshot manually. Date-stamp every snapshot.

3

Cross-reference against your authorized seller list

Compare every seller name against your distributor, wholesale, and reseller agreements. Anything not on the list is — by definition — unauthorized. There is no gray zone.

4

Tag each unauthorized seller with a vector

Use the diagnostic from Section 02. Tag, time-stamp, and screenshot each rogue. This becomes evidence.

5

Calculate channel exposure

Run a weighted Buy Box analysis: % of time the Buy Box was held by an unauthorized seller × your ASIN revenue. That number is your annualized channel-leak. Show it to your CFO. Watch the budget appear.

Service providers we trust for enforcement work

Don't try to build this in-house from scratch. The brand-protection space has specialists who do this every day, and the right partner pays for itself quickly in recovered Buy Box share. These are the providers we work with directly:

Thorncrest	Brand-protection counsel and unauthorized-seller enforcement. Strong with C&D escalation, MAP enforcement, and seller investigations across U.S. jurisdictions.
IP Shark	Monitoring + takedown platform purpose-built for Amazon. Useful for ongoing seller-landscape tracking, alias detection, and structured violation submissions.
Edison IP Enforcement	Full-service IP and brand-protection enforcement. Good fit when you need investigative depth (test buys, supply-chain mapping, multi-jurisdiction cases) alongside legal action.

Cadence

Quarterly is too slow. Run a full audit at least **monthly** on every live ASIN — **weekly** if you're under active attack or in a category where unauthorized resale spikes (supplements, beauty, electronics). Tie audit completion to a recurring calendar event with a named owner. Audit cadence is the single most neglected control in Amazon brand management.

TIP

What 'authorized' actually means

An authorized seller is one who has a written agreement that specifically grants the right to resell on Amazon. A wholesale agreement alone does **not** authorize Amazon resale. If your current contracts are silent on channel restrictions, every wholesale customer is a potential diverter — and you have no contractual leverage when they show up on your listing.

04

SECTION 04

Build the foundation

Operating model first. Then Brand Registry, MAP, and reseller agreements.

Four pillars. Skip any one of them and unauthorized sellers will exploit the gap within weeks. Pillar 01 is the one most brand owners never even look at — but it's the threshold question that determines whether the rest of this playbook will work for you at all.

01 · Pick the right operating model — 3P (Seller Central)

If you're on Vendor Central (1P), Amazon is the seller — and Amazon does not honor your MAP. Amazon's algorithm prices wherever it wants, which trains the market to expect your product at a discount, drags down your authorized retail partners, and removes your strongest enforcement lever before the fight starts. Move to Seller Central (3P). Once you control the offer, every other tool in this playbook starts to actually work.

Why 3P wins for brand protection:

- **Pricing discipline you actually own.** On 3P you set price. On 1P, Amazon's algorithm will undercut MAP without warning, and you have no recourse. Once Amazon prices low, every diverter and hijacker matches it — and your retail partners stop reordering.
- **Direct control of the offer.** On 3P you can pull the offer, change fulfillment, or restock strategically when an unauthorized seller is active. On 1P, Amazon decides the offer state — and Amazon's interests aren't your interests.
- **Direct control of the listing.** Title, bullets, images, A+ Content, video — on 3P you push changes the same day. On 1P, edits route through Amazon's catalog team and can take weeks, sit in queues, or get reverted.
- **Visible economics.** On 3P, every fee, return, refund, and reimbursement is visible. On 1P, you sell into a black box at a fixed wholesale price and never see Amazon's actual margin or the true cost of returns.
- **Inventory you actually own.** On 3P, you decide what's in stock and when. On 1P, Amazon issues POs with no minimums and can stop buying any SKU at any time — and stock-outs are exactly the moment unauthorized sellers move in.

CRITICAL**If you're on 1P right now**

Your MAP policy is unenforceable against Amazon itself, and unauthorized sellers know it. The first real move in the unauthorized seller fight is a 1P → 3P transition. It's a 60–120 day project, but without it the rest of this playbook gives you a fraction of the result.

The other three pillars

02 · Amazon Brand Registry

Non-negotiable. Required to file IP infringement reports, reach the Brand Registry support team, and unlock Project Zero and Transparency. Requires an active registered trademark (USPTO or equivalent) — start the trademark application this week if you don't have one. **2026 enforcement update:** Amazon is actively deactivating new ASINs created by unauthorized sellers on brand-registered products — sellers must produce a Letter of Authorization or invoices from an authorized distributor to keep the listing live. Meaningful step (the invoice cure also exposes which of your distributors is leaking), but it only affects ASIN *creation* under your registered brand — not unauthorized sellers piggybacking on your existing listings, and not the common workaround of re-listing the same physical product under brand "Generic" or under the seller's own trademarked brand (e.g., "AWEGOO"). Different brand label, same product underneath, new ASIN that brand-registry enforcement doesn't reach. Don't mistake it for a cure.

03 · A real MAP policy (with teeth)

A Minimum Advertised Price policy is unilateral — you set it, you enforce it, no negotiation. It must define the price floor, list every covered ASIN, specify the violation review window, and name the enforcement consequences. Without a written, distributed MAP, you have nothing to point at when you terminate a diverter.

04 · Authorized Reseller Agreements

Every wholesale and distribution contract must include: a channel-restriction clause that names Amazon explicitly, a MAP compliance clause, an audit-and-termination provision, and a first-sale-doctrine carve-out. Without these, the first-sale doctrine is your single biggest vulnerability — and unauthorized sellers know it.

CRITICAL

The first-sale doctrine — read carefully

Under U.S. law, once you sell a unit, the buyer can usually resell it. This is why diverters love wholesale brands: "I bought it legally, I can sell it anywhere." Three ways to defeat the defense:

(1) Cannot be sold as "New". Your warranty only transfers through authorized channels, and quality-control standards (storage temperature, humidity, handling, expiration tracking) can't be ensured for product that passed through an unauthorized seller. A unit without a valid warranty or documented chain of custody is not legitimately a New product on Amazon — it's used or refurbished at best.

(2) Material differences. Authorized units carry warranty, serialization, packaging, or service touch-points the diverted units don't. Document each one explicitly.

(3) Contract. Your wholesale agreement explicitly forbids Amazon resale and gives you termination rights when it happens.

Infrastructure that compounds

Once the four pillars are in place, layer in these multipliers. Each one adds friction for unauthorized sellers and durability for your enforcement program.

A+ Content & Brand Story	Saturate your listing with brand-controlled content. Saboteurs can't easily edit A+ modules, and customers anchor on brand-curated content over hijacker variations.
Material differences program	Document warranty terms, quality-control standards (storage temp, humidity, expiration tracking), serialization, packaging, and service touch-points available only through authorized channels. This is the legal hook that defeats first-sale — and the reason diverted units cannot be sold as "New."
Test-buy operations	Run all test buys from the Brand Registered Owner account so the order ID is admissible in Brand Registry submissions. Build a documented chain of custody from order to physical storage.

WATCH OUT

Project Zero and Transparency — last resort, not first move

These programs come up in every brand-protection conversation. They are powerful, but they are the **last resort**, not part of the foundation. Pursue them only when contracts, MAP, Brand Registry violations, and C&D escalation have failed to control the situation. The operational burden is real — Transparency in particular requires a unique serialized code on every unit you ship, which is a permanent supply-chain change. Don't enroll until you know you need it.

ACTION

Action — Get the foundation moving

Foundation work is sequenced, not deadline-driven. Some of it (trademark registration, contract redlines) takes weeks or months and depends on third parties. Start in this order, in parallel where you can: **(1)** trademark + Brand Registry application, **(2)** draft and distribute your MAP policy, **(3)** redline wholesale agreements, **(4)** document material differences. Don't wait for everything to finish before you start running cases in Section 05 — but don't ship the playbook without the foundation either.

05

SECTION 05

The 7-step removal playbook

From first detection to delisted — the exact sequence we use internally.

This is the core sequence. Run every rogue through every step in order. Skipping steps is the #1 reason removals fail or come back within 30 days.

1

Document the violation

Before contact, capture: the ASIN page, the Offers page, the seller's storefront, the seller's listing details (price, fulfillment method), and the time-stamped URL. Save everything as PDFs with metadata. This is your evidence file — without it, every later step is weaker.

2

Run a Brand Registry test buy

Place the order from your **Brand Registered Owner account** — the order ID is what Amazon will cite when they enforce. Record the unboxing as one continuous take. Keep packaging, labels, and the unit in chain-of-custody storage. Note material differences vs. your authentic product (warranty, serialization, packaging variant). Full SOP in Section 06.

3

Identify the seller's real-world entity

Use the Amazon storefront's 'Detailed Seller Information' (legal name, business address, phone). Cross-reference with state business filings, LinkedIn, and prior takedown databases. You need a real human and a real address to send the C&D.

The 7-step removal playbook (continued)

4

Send a tiered cease & desist

Use the templates in Section 07. Start with Tier 1 (firm, no legal threats). Escalate to Tier 2 (legal counsel CC'd) if there's no response in 5 business days. Tier 3 (attorney-signed) is your final pre-litigation step. Each tier compounds the credibility of the next.

5

File the Amazon Report a Violation

Only after C&D is sent and documented (Amazon weights this). Choose the violation type carefully — see Section 08. Reference your evidence file. Avoid emotional language. Stick to facts and exhibits.

6

Escalate via Brand Registry support

If the report-a-violation submission stalls beyond 7 days, escalate through Brand Registry's support contact form, attaching the case ID and a one-paragraph timeline. Specialists triage these differently than general Seller Support.

WATCH OUT

Don't skip Step 1

Brands lose more cases at evidence than at any other stage. Document **before** you contact. Once a rogue knows you're watching, listings change, evidence disappears, and Amazon's logs may not preserve what you needed.

The 7-step removal playbook (continued)

7

Re-audit and reinforce

Once delisted, re-audit the ASIN within 72 hours. Most rogues attempt to relist under a sister account. Add the seller's known aliases, addresses, and storefront patterns to your monitoring rules. This step is what converts removal into prevention.

TIP

If a case is dragging past 30 days, look at evidence and category

When a removal stalls, the cause is almost always one of two things: thin evidence at Step 1, or the wrong violation category in Step 5. Pull the case file, fix the upstream gap, and resubmit. Don't just pile on more reports.

ACTION

Action — Run one full case this week

Pick the single most damaging rogue from your audit. Take it through all seven steps yourself. Document your time per step. **That's your baseline** — and the input to deciding whether to build internal capacity or bring in a partner.

06

SECTION 06

The test buy SOP

How to capture evidence Amazon Brand Registry will actually act on.

Most operators run test buys from a personal Amazon account thinking it keeps the unauthorized seller from spotting them. That's a mistake. Brand Registry can only enforce on orders it can tie to **your** brand-registered account — the order ID is the cornerstone of every infringement submission. Buy from anywhere else and Amazon won't touch it.

CRITICAL
The non-negotiable

The test buy must be placed from your **Brand Registered Owner account** (or a Brand Registry user explicitly authorized under it). The order ID is what you cite in your Brand Registry violation report. No order ID tied to your brand account = no enforcement.

1

Buy from the Brand Registered Owner account

Use the registered brand owner account or a Brand Registry-linked sub-user. The seller will see your name on the receipt — that's fine. The audience for this buy is Amazon's enforcement team, not the seller, and they need the order traceable to your case file.

2

Order at the violation moment

Place the order while the unauthorized seller holds the Buy Box. Time-stamp screenshot the offer page: price, seller name, fulfillment method, ASIN, and the Detailed Seller Information panel.

3

Save the order ID, confirmation, and seller details

The order ID is the single most important artifact — it's what you'll cite in the Brand Registry violation report. The confirmation email captures the seller's legal entity in the receipt header.

4

Record a single, continuous unboxing

Show the shipping label, exterior packaging, every interior component, inserts, and invoices. No edits, no re-encoding. Continuous video preserves chain of custody.

5

Inspect for material differences

Compare to your authentic specimen: serialization, warranty inserts, packaging variant, manufacturing date codes, accessory completeness. Side-by-side photos. This defeats first-sale.

6

Preserve the unit and repeat on every violation cycle

Label and seal the unit with the order ID, ASIN, date, and inspector. Store physically until the case closes. If the seller relists, run a fresh buy on each cycle — Amazon weighs corroborated, time-stamped patterns more heavily than a single snapshot.

07

SECTION 07

Cease & desist templates

Three escalation tiers — copy, paste, send. Adapt to your facts.

These are working templates we use internally. They are **not** legal advice. Have your counsel review the final version before sending — but use this as the structural baseline.

Tier 1 — Direct, firm, no legal escalation

TIP**When to use Tier 1**

First contact with any unauthorized seller. Goal: voluntary delisting within 5 business days. Most opportunistic resellers comply at this tier alone — the firm tone and 5-day deadline do the work without legal escalation.

Subject: Unauthorized Sale of [BRAND] Products on Amazon — Action Required

Dear [Seller Legal Name],

[Brand] is the registered owner of trademark [TRADEMARK #] and the manufacturer of the product sold under ASIN [ASIN]. We have identified [Storefront Name] as offering this product on Amazon without authorization from [Brand].

[Brand] sells through a controlled network of authorized retailers. [Storefront Name] is not on that list. Because units sold outside that network are not subject to [Brand]'s warranty, quality-control, storage, and handling requirements, the units you are offering **cannot be legitimately listed as "New"** under Amazon's condition guidelines — the warranty does not transfer, and chain-of-custody quality controls cannot be documented.

Continued sale of [Brand] products on Amazon constitutes (1) violation of [Brand]'s sales policy, (2) misrepresentation of product condition, (3) potential trademark infringement based on material differences from authentic [Brand] product, and (4) interference with [Brand]'s authorized distribution network.

We require that you:

1. Remove all [Brand] product listings from Amazon within 5 business days of this notice.
2. Confirm in writing that you have done so.
3. Not relist [Brand] products on Amazon under any account.

If we do not receive confirmation by [DATE], we will escalate this matter to Amazon's Brand Registry and pursue all remedies available, including formal legal action.

Sincerely,

[Name], [Title]

[Brand] · brand-protection@yourdomain.com

Tier 2 – Counsel CC'd, pre-litigation framing

TIP

When to use Tier 2

If Tier 1 expires without compliance. CC your counsel (real or contracted). The combination of documented prior notice plus a real attorney name on the email tends to clear most remaining non-counterfeit cases.

Subject: Second Notice – Unauthorized Sale of [BRAND] Products / Pre-Litigation

Dear [Seller Legal Name],

This is our second and final notice prior to commencement of formal proceedings. On [DATE] we notified you that [Storefront Name] was offering [Brand] products on Amazon without authorization. To date, the listings remain active.

Counsel for [Brand] (CC'd) is now engaged in this matter. Please be advised:

1. We have completed a documented test purchase establishing [counterfeit / material differences / MAP violation / misrepresented condition], evidence of which is preserved.
2. The unit you sold cannot be legitimately listed as "New" because [Brand]'s warranty does not transfer outside its authorized network and quality-control standards (storage, handling, expiration tracking) cannot be ensured for diverted product. This is a misrepresentation of product condition under Amazon's policies.
3. We have submitted a Brand Registry violation report to Amazon citing trademark infringement and material differences from authentic [Brand] product.
4. We are prepared to file in [JURISDICTION] for trademark infringement, unfair competition, and tortious interference, and to seek injunctive relief, monetary damages, and recovery of attorney's fees.

To resolve this matter without litigation, you must by [DATE + 5 BUSINESS DAYS]:

(a) remove all [Brand] listings from Amazon and any other platform; (b) confirm removal in writing; (c) provide a list of all wholesale or supply sources for [Brand] product in your possession.

Failure to respond will be treated as confirmation of intent to continue infringing conduct.

Sincerely,

[Name], [Title], [Brand]

CC: [Counsel name & firm]

CRITICAL

Tier 3 (attorney-signed)

Tier 3 is sent on counsel's letterhead with jurisdiction-specific litigation references. We don't reproduce that template here because it has to be drafted by your attorney for your facts and venue. The remaining holdouts after Tier 2 are the ones where Tier 3 – or filing – is the answer.

08

SECTION 08

Amazon's Report a Violation tool

What works, what doesn't, and how to phrase the submission for fastest action.

Brand Registry's Report a Violation tool is your most direct path to platform action — but how you categorize and phrase the submission determines whether it closes in 2 days or 22.

Choosing the right violation type

Trademark infringement / material differences	Use when the unit materially differs from authentic [Brand] product — invalid warranty, missing quality-control standards, packaging variance, missing serialization. Frame the report explicitly around "cannot be sold as New" for diverted product. Don't mis-classify a pure MAP violation as trademark infringement; Amazon will dismiss it and your future reports get weighted lower.
Counterfeit	Reserve for documented counterfeit cases with test-buy evidence. The strongest tool in your arsenal. Counterfeit cases with documented test-buy evidence move faster through Brand Registry than any other category.
Condition misrepresentation	Use when an unauthorized seller is offering diverted product as "New" without a valid warranty or documented chain of custody — a direct Amazon condition-policy violation.
Right of publicity / image use	When a seller uses unauthorized photography of yours. Lower priority than counterfeit but consistently effective.
Listing abuse	For listing saboteurs editing your title or images. File through the Brand Registry contributions tool, not the general report-a-violation form.

TIP**Phrasing that gets action**

Lead with the violation type and the ASIN. State the specific facts in 3–5 sentences. Reference your evidence by exhibit number. Do not editorialize. Brand Registry reviewers process a high volume of submissions — clean, factual, exhibit-referenced reports get actioned. Emotional submissions get queued.

09

SECTION 09

When to bring in a lawyer

Five signals it's time to escalate beyond Amazon's internal tools.

Amazon has dismissed your report twice

When in-platform remediation has failed, your next step is a federal infringement claim. Amazon responds differently to a filed lawsuit than to an internal report.

The same actor relists under aliases

Sophisticated infringers operate multiple LLCs. Investigation and discovery require legal process.

You've identified a counterfeit ring

Multiple sellers, common warehouse, common unit characteristics. This is organized — and a single civil action against the ring is more efficient than 20 takedowns.

Your authorized retailers are threatening to leave

Channel-conflict damages compound quickly. Documented, unmitigated rogue activity is a retainer-event.

You suspect insider involvement

When a former employee, distributor, or warehouse partner is the source, contractual remedies and potentially criminal trade-secret claims become available.

ACTION

Build the relationship before you need it

Don't wait for a crisis to find counsel. Identify and brief an Amazon-experienced IP firm *before* you need to file. When the moment comes, you'll skip 2–3 weeks of onboarding.

10

SECTION 10

Your Phase A / B / C plan

How OBG runs this — phased, not piecemeal. Realistic timing, not a sprint.

Brand protection isn't a 90-day sprint. Foundation work depends on third parties — trademark offices, attorneys, distributors — and takes as long as it takes. Phase B starts the moment you have enough foundation in place to run cases. Phase C never ends. Use this as a sequence, not a calendar.

PHASE A · FOUNDATION (run in parallel; expect weeks to months)

- ☐ Confirm or initiate trademark registration; enroll in Amazon Brand Registry
- ☐ Decide your operating model — 3P (Seller Central) is the default for protection
- ☐ Run the full seller audit (Section 03) on every live ASIN
- ☐ Draft and distribute a written MAP policy with named enforcement consequences
- ☐ Redline wholesale agreements: channel restriction, MAP, audit, termination rights
- ☐ Document the material differences that defeat first-sale (warranty, QC, packaging)
- ☐ Run one full removal case end-to-end (Section 05) to set your baseline

PHASE B · BUILD & EXPAND (begins as soon as foundation supports it)

- ☐ Send Tier 1 C&D to every unauthorized seller identified in audit
- ☐ Escalate non-responders to Tier 2 with counsel CC'd
- ☐ File Brand Registry violations citing condition misrepresentation and material differences
- ☐ Build a seller-alias database — track relisting attempts
- ☐ Brief outside IP counsel and place on retainer
- ☐ Stand up FBA inventory governance — no stock-outs unauthorized sellers exploit
- ☐ Reconcile FBA reimbursements (lost / damaged / fee errors)

PHASE C · SCALE (ongoing — this never ends)

- ☐ Audit at least monthly on every live ASIN — weekly if under active attack
- ☐ Tighten the authorized reseller list — terminate non-compliant accounts
- ☐ Quarterly channel-leak P&L review with leadership — show the recovered margin
- ☐ Reduce ad dependency — recovered Buy Box share is organic revenue you stop paying for
- ☐ Calibrate the monitoring stack against the next stage of GMV growth
- ☐ Project Zero / Transparency — only if all of the above haven't worked

QUICK-REFERENCE

The Unauthorized Seller Checklist

Print this. Pin it above your desk. Tick it monthly.

Foundation (one-time)

- ☐ Trademark registered
- ☐ Brand Registry approved
- ☐ MAP policy written and distributed
- ☐ Authorized reseller agreements updated
- ☐ Material differences documented
- ☐ Counsel briefed and on retainer

Detection (monthly minimum, weekly under attack)

- ☐ Run a full audit on every live ASIN — not just hero SKUs
- ☐ Tag new sellers with vector type
- ☐ Update the seller-alias database
- ☐ Calculate weekly Buy Box exposure

Action (per rogue)

- ☐ Documentation file created
- ☐ Test buy complete with chain of custody
- ☐ Tier 1 C&D sent
- ☐ Tier 2 sent if no response in 5 business days
- ☐ Brand Registry violation filed
- ☐ Re-audit at +72 hours after takedown

Quarterly review

- ☐ Channel-leak P&L number presented to leadership
- ☐ Tooling stack reviewed against current GMV stage
- ☐ Authorized reseller list audited and pruned
- ☐ Counsel debrief on outstanding matters

ABOUT

Online Brand Growth

Amazon brand management for serious operators.

Founder-led Amazon brand management. We work with operators ready to protect margin, defend the Buy Box, and turn Amazon from a leaky retail account into a real profit center.

We charge a percentage of channel Contribution Margin — not ad spend, not gross revenue. When the channel makes more money, we do. That's the only model where agency incentives line up with yours.

What we do

Brand protection	Audit, takedown, and ongoing monitoring of unauthorized sellers — the playbook in your hands.
Logistics & operations	FBA inventory governance, shipment planning, reimbursements, removal orders, FBM where it makes sense.
SEO & CRO optimization	Title, bullets, A+ Content, video, brand store, variation strategy — built for both rank and conversion.
Advertising	Sponsored Products, Brands, and Display engineered for channel Contribution Margin, not vanity ROAS.
Channel architecture	Operating-model decisions (3P vs 1P), MAP policy design, authorized reseller programs, contract redlining.

\$30M+

in annual brand revenue managed

7-figure

brands built across the team

100%

Amazon — that's all we do

TIP

Want our team to run this for you?

Most operators we work with run this playbook with OBG holding the rope — we do the audit, the test buys, the takedown letters, the monitoring, and the reporting. Your team owns the thing only you can own: the brand itself. Book a call below.

READY TO TAKE YOUR CHANNEL BACK?

Book a free 30-minute strategy call.

Bring the audit you ran (Section 03) and the case you worked (Section 05). We'll review your seller landscape, identify the highest-impact takedowns, and map a phased plan tailored to your catalog. No obligation, no pitch deck — just our team and yours.

Book a Call →

PROTECT

Take rogues off your listings

DEFEND

Build a channel they can't re-enter

GROW

Margin recovered, reinvested in growth